

# 2-3 Minute Game Showcase Video Plan

## Goal

Create a **class/project demo** that quickly explains the game's premise, shows the playable loop, and highlights the strongest implemented features without lingering on debug tooling.

**Target runtime:** ~2:30, hard cap 3:00

**Voiceover style:** darkly funny, but still clear

**Demo method:** debug shortcuts may be used to stage footage, but should be hidden from the final cut

**Priority:** balanced mix of premise, AI companions, overworld, dungeon, combat, loot, upgrades, and progression UI

## Core Message

The player is a lonely witch cat trying to make friends in a world where companionship is useful, risky, and a little manipulative. NPC companions generate quest flavor through AI, send the player into dangerous dungeons, and feed the main loop:

**Talk to a companion → accept a quest → enter a dungeon → fight enemies → loot chests → return → upgrade → repeat.**

## Setup Checklist

1. Start LM Studio if AI dialogue will be shown live.
2. Start the AI bridge:

```
cd ai
pnpm dev:server
```

3. Start the game:

```
cd game
npm run dev
```

4. Use a prepared save or staged state with:
  - at least one visible AI companion,
  - at least one quest available or ready to accept,
  - some inventory materials/currency for shop or upgrade footage,

- a dungeon layout that is quick to clear on camera.
5. If needed, use hidden setup shortcuts before recording final takes:
- conversation phrase: `I will do it` to force quest activation,
  - dungeon debug keys only off-camera to stage clears/chests/floor transitions,
  - creative item gallery only off-camera to seed upgrade/shop materials.

## Storyboard / Shot Plan

| Time      | Shot                       | What to Show                                                                                                                                                 | Potential Voiceover                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00–0:12 | Title + premise            | Start on overworld with witch cat visible. Slow pan/walk through the field toward town.                                                                      | “You play as a lonely witch cat with one very dangerous flaw: she wants people to like her.”                                                                |
| 0:12–0:30 | Overworld exploration      | Show handcrafted village/outskirts, minimap, landmarks, town NPCs, dungeon gate route.                                                                       | “The safe-looking village is the hub: shops, upgrades, companions, and the road to absolutely questionable life choices.”                                   |
| 0:30–0:55 | AI companion interaction   | Approach Ember Voss / another active companion, press <b>E</b> , show parchment conversation UI, portrait, archetype label, typed player input, AI response. | “Companions are AI-driven archetypes. They remember context, offer quests, and frame dangerous errands as proof that you’re special.”                       |
| 0:55–1:10 | Quest activation + follow  | Show quest toast, portal label, companion following the player after quest start.                                                                            | “When you accept, the quest becomes a playable dungeon run, and your new ‘friend’ follows just close enough to feel supportive — not close enough to help.” |
| 1:10–1:35 | Dungeon entry + floor loop | Enter dungeon, show curated layout, enemy/chest counters,                                                                                                    | “Dungeons are repeatable, curated                                                                                                                           |

| Time      | Shot                                  | What to Show                                                                                                          | Potential Voiceover                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|           |                                       | distinct dungeon visual theme, roaming enemies chasing through rooms.                                                 | layouts with roaming enemies, chest objectives, and a clear rule: clear the floor before moving on.”                                                      |
| 1:35–2:00 | Turn-based combat                     | Trigger combat. Show polished battle screen and command flow: Attack, Heavy, Item, Defend. Use one item if available. | “Combat is turn-based. Basic attacks are reliable, heavy strikes hit harder with risk and cooldown, items spend a turn, and defending can save a run.”    |
| 2:00–2:18 | Loot + progression portal             | Return to dungeon, open chest, show reward text/inventory update, then show progression/exit portal.                  | “Victory is only half the job. The game makes you collect the reward too, because apparently friendship has paperwork.”                                   |
| 2:18–2:38 | Return + upgrades/shop                | Return to overworld. Show latest reward, inventory, shop purchase or Claws/Ward/Guard upgrade prompt.                 | “Dungeon loot feeds the village economy: buy consumables, upgrade attack, health, or guard strength, then survive worse favors from better manipulators.” |
| 2:38–2:55 | Codex/friend roster + closing montage | Briefly open Lore Codex and/or Friend Roster. End on the companion/town/dungeon gate.                                 | “The codex tracks quests, the roster tracks relationships, and the big question stays the same: are you getting stronger, or just easier to use?”         |

# Must-Capture Feature Beats

- **Premise:** lonely witch cat seeking connection in an exploitative companion system.
- **AI companions:** in-game conversation overlay, archetype personality, quest generation/acceptance.
- **Quest feedback:** toast notification, quest title/portal labeling, companion follow behavior.
- **Overworld:** handcrafted route, town roles, minimap, dungeon gate.
- **Dungeon:** curated multi-room layouts, enemies, chests, floor completion portal.
- **Combat:** turn-based command UI with Attack / Heavy / Item / Defend and animated feedback.
- **Rewards/progression:** chest loot, inventory, shop buying, stat upgrades.
- **Persistence/UI:** lore codex and friend roster as quick proof of longer-term quest and relationship tracking.

## Editing Notes

- Use quick cuts; do not show full traversal or full battles.
- Hide loading, debug overlays, failed AI requests, and staging shortcuts.
- If AI response time is slow, record the conversation after the response appears and cut out the waiting.
- Keep UI text readable for at least 1–2 seconds when showing toasts, inventory, upgrades, or codex entries.
- Use captions for controls only when helpful: **E Talk, E Enter Dungeon, 1 Attack, 2 Heavy, 3 Item, 4 Defend, I Inventory, C Codex, F Friends.**

## Suggested Closing Line

“It’s a dungeon RPG about getting stronger by doing favors for people who may or may not deserve you — mostly not.”